Phone bill decoder

What each line means, and where money usually leaks

POSEIDON NETWORK SYSTEMS
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Most business phone bills have a few lines nobody has looked at in years. Use this page with your latest bill in front of you. It takes about 10 minutes.

1. What each part of the bill means

On your bill	What it is	What to check
Line rental / access fee	A fixed monthly charge for each phone line or number, whether it's used or not.	Count the lines. Does every line still belong to someone who works with you?
Service / account fees	Fixed admin or platform charges added every month.	Are you paying for anything you don't recognise?
Calls to landlines	Charges for calls to other fixed-line numbers, often split into local and national.	Look at the minutes as well as the rands.
Calls to mobiles	Usually the most expensive call type per minute.	If most of your calls go to cellphones, this is where VoIP often saves most.
International calls	Calls to numbers outside South Africa.	A few long calls can cost more than a month of local calls.
Value-added services	Extras such as call forwarding, voicemail, caller ID or a call menu.	Forwarding calls to cellphones is often charged as a mobile call.
Equipment rental	Monthly rental for handsets or an on-site switchboard (PABX).	Many offices still rent equipment they bought years ago, or no longer use.
Fax lines	A separate line for a fax machine.	If nobody has sent a fax this year, it's a line you're paying for.
Contract / term details	The start date and length of any contract on the account.	Note the end date before deciding anything.

2. The five most common wasted costs

- Lines still active for staff who've left, or for an old fax machine.
- Equipment rental on an old switchboard or handsets that have been paid for many times over.
- Calls forwarded to cellphones because staff work from home, charged at mobile rates every time.
- Value-added services switched on years ago and never used.
- A contract that renewed automatically on old rates, because nobody noted the end date.

3. Your quick check

Question	Your answer
How many lines or numbers are on the bill?	
How many do you actually use?	
What's the total each month, incl. VAT?	
How much is calls to cellphones?	
Is there equipment or fax line rental?	
When does your current contract end?	

Want the full picture? WhatsApp a photo of your bill to 062 788 3650. Within one business day we'll send a free one-page comparison: what you pay now, and what the same lines and calls would cost on Switch Telecom VoIP. If your current deal is good, we'll tell you.

Your bill is used only for the comparison and deleted afterwards. Privacy questions: privacy@poseidon-network.com. Poseidon Network Systems is an authorised Switch Telecom reseller.